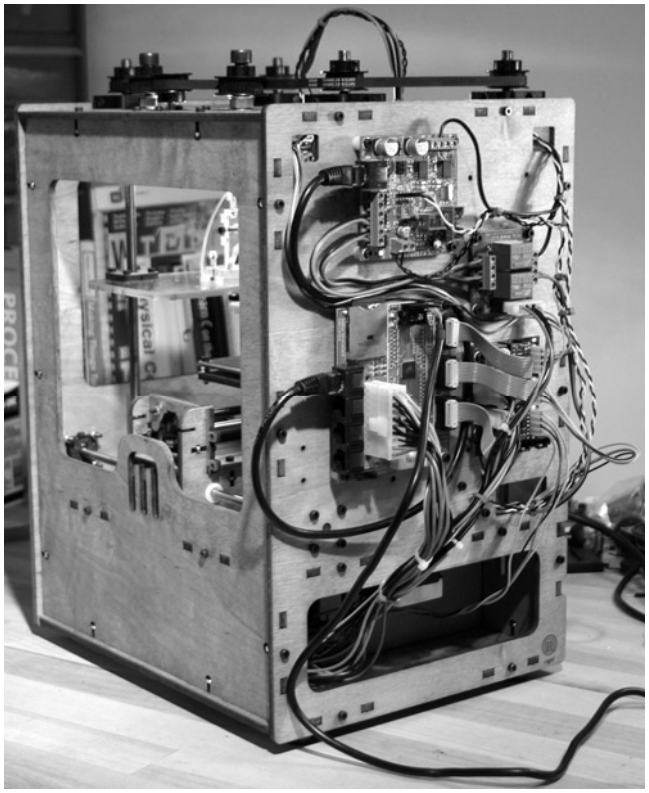


Figure 1-5. *MakerBot CupCake 3D printer with Arduino-compatible electronics*

Or for all of those brown thumbs out there that can never seem to water their house plants when it's most needed, a team of New York University students developed a tweeting plant moisture meter called Botanicalls, shown in Figure 1-6. Based on the Arduino reference design, combined with an off-the-shelf Ethernet module and a simple moisture probe all wrapped up in a leafy-green circuit board, the Botanicalls device will post a tweet and blink an LED whenever the soil moisture of the plant falls below a certain threshold, letting its owner know that they should get out their watering can.